

Intersection of lines and planes

Basic skills

Q1. a) $\underline{r} = \begin{pmatrix} 5 + \lambda \\ -2 + 2\lambda \\ 4 - 2\lambda \end{pmatrix}$ so $\begin{aligned} x &= 5 + \lambda \\ y &= 2\lambda - 2 \\ z &= 4 - 2\lambda \end{aligned}$

b) $\underline{r} = \begin{pmatrix} 7 - 2\mu \\ \mu \\ -3 \end{pmatrix}$ $\begin{aligned} x &= 7 - 2\mu \\ y &= \mu \\ z &= -3 \end{aligned}$

c) $\underline{r} = \begin{pmatrix} 5 + \lambda - 5\mu \\ -2 + 2\lambda - 2\mu \\ 4 - 2\lambda - \mu \end{pmatrix}$ $\begin{aligned} x &= 5 + \lambda - 5\mu \\ y &= -2 + 2\lambda - 2\mu \\ z &= 4 - 2\lambda - \mu \end{aligned}$

Q2. Normal $\underline{n} = \begin{pmatrix} -2 \\ -1 \\ 0 \end{pmatrix}$

$$\text{so } -2x - y = d$$

sub point $(5, 2, 1)$

$$\Rightarrow -10 - 2 = d \\ d = -12$$

$$\text{so } -2x - y = -12 \Leftrightarrow 2x + y = 12$$

Q3. $2 + 3\lambda = -4 + 6\mu$
 $3 + 2\lambda = -10\mu$
 $5 + 5\lambda = 8 - 3\mu$

$$x(\lambda) = x(\mu)$$

$$y(\lambda) = y(\mu)$$

$$z(\lambda) = z(\mu)$$

$$\Rightarrow \mu = -\frac{3}{10} - \frac{2}{10}\lambda$$

so $2 + 3\lambda = -4 - \frac{18}{10} - \frac{12}{10}\lambda$

$$\Rightarrow \frac{42}{10}\lambda = -\frac{39}{5} \quad \lambda = -\frac{13}{7}$$

$$\Rightarrow \mu = -\frac{3}{10} - \frac{2}{10} \times -\frac{13}{7} = \frac{1}{14}$$

Now check

$$5 + 5 \times -\frac{13}{7} = -\frac{30}{7}, \quad 8 - 3 \times \frac{1}{14} = \frac{109}{14}$$

not consistent so no point of intersection

The lines ℓ_1 and ℓ_2 are skew

Competency skills

Q4. $\Gamma = \begin{pmatrix} 2+\lambda \\ 3 \\ 5+5\lambda \end{pmatrix}, 2x - y + z = 13$

a) $x = 2 + \lambda$

$$y = 3$$

$$z = 5 + 5\lambda$$

b) $2(2 + \lambda) - 3 + 5 + 5\lambda = 13$

$$\Rightarrow 7\lambda = 7 \Rightarrow \lambda = 1$$

so $x = 3, y = 3, z = 10$

$(3, 3, 10)$ is point of intersection

Q5.

$$x = 4 + 4\lambda$$

$$y = -1 + 2\lambda$$

$$z = 3 - \lambda$$

$$\Rightarrow 3x + 2y + z = 16$$

becomes

$$12 + 12\lambda - 2 + 4\lambda + 3 - \lambda = 16$$

$$\Rightarrow 15\lambda = 3 \quad \lambda = \frac{1}{5}$$

so $x = 4 + \frac{4}{5} = \frac{24}{5}, y = -1 + \frac{2}{5} = -\frac{3}{5}, z = 3 - \frac{1}{5} = \frac{14}{5}$

So point of intersection is

$$\left(\frac{24}{5}, -\frac{3}{5}, \frac{14}{5} \right)$$

Q6.

$$x = s + 2t$$

$$y = 1$$

$$z = -1 - t$$

$$\text{so } y + 6z = 10 - 3x$$

$$\Rightarrow 1 - 6 - 6t = 10 - 1s - 6t$$

$$\Rightarrow -5 - 6t = -5 - 6t \Rightarrow 0 = 0$$

so true for all t . Hence all points on the line are in the plane

Q7.

$$x = 2\lambda$$

$$y = 3 - \lambda$$

$$z = 4 + 3\lambda$$

$$\text{so } \underline{r} \cdot \underline{n} = 0$$

$$\Rightarrow \begin{pmatrix} 2\lambda \\ 3-\lambda \\ 4+3\lambda \end{pmatrix} \cdot \begin{pmatrix} 2 \\ 5 \\ -1 \end{pmatrix} = 0$$

$$\Rightarrow 4\lambda + 15 - 5\lambda - 4 - 3\lambda = 0 \Rightarrow 4\lambda = 11$$

$$\text{so } \lambda = \frac{11}{4} \Rightarrow x = \frac{11}{2}, y = \frac{1}{4}, z = \frac{49}{4}$$

Q8. L_1 is $\vec{r} = \begin{pmatrix} 2 \\ 3 \\ -5 \end{pmatrix} + \lambda \begin{pmatrix} -8 \\ 1 \\ 2 \end{pmatrix}$ or $\begin{pmatrix} -4 \\ 0.5 \\ 1 \end{pmatrix}$

and so

$$x = 2 - 8\lambda$$

$$3x + y - z = -5$$

$$y = 3 + \lambda \quad \text{so}$$

$$z = -5 + 2\lambda$$

$$\Rightarrow 6 - 18\lambda + 3 + \lambda + 5 - 2\lambda = -5$$

$$\Rightarrow -19\lambda = -19$$

$$\Rightarrow \lambda = 1 \text{ and so } x = -6, y = 4, z = -3$$

$$(-6, 4, -3)$$

Q9. planes are $5x + 2y = 0$

$$x + 2y - z = 0$$

$$4x + z = 0$$

$$\Rightarrow z = -4x \text{ and } x = -\frac{2}{8}y$$

$$\text{so } z = \frac{8}{5}y \Rightarrow -4x = \frac{8}{5}y = z$$

is the line of points

Q10.

$$x = 1 + 2kt$$

$$y = 3 + t$$

$$z = 3 + 5t$$

$$1 + 2kt + 3 + t - 3 - 5t = 1$$

$$\Rightarrow \Rightarrow 1 + (2k - 4)t = 1$$

To be contained all t must work so $2k - 4 = 0 \Rightarrow k = 2$